

01 Get it

02 Trust it

03 Use it

04 Stretch it

MCP 101 · USE IT · BETTER HABITS WITH AI

Instead of this, *do this*

19 swaps across three roles for the habits that keep Claude and Backstory from doing their best work.

People keep their old habits and *bolt Claude onto the end of them.*

Change the habit, and Claude stops being an extra step. It does the gathering, and you start from the answer. Every card applies one of three shifts. **Small changes, big impact.**

01

Ask, don't gather

Instead of opening six tabs before a call, ask for the brief.

02

Pull live, don't paste

Instead of pasting CRM notes into Claude, let it pull them live, so nothing goes stale.

03

Be specific, not general

Instead of "How's my pipeline?", ask a question with a filter, a time window and a signal.



ROLE 01 · HABITS TO CHANGE

Account executive

Prep, follow-up and deal strategy, without the tab hunt.

01 Before the call

Pre-call prep · Deal updates

02 Sharpen the question

Pipeline check · Stakeholder map · Deal risk

03 After the call

Follow-up email · Precedent

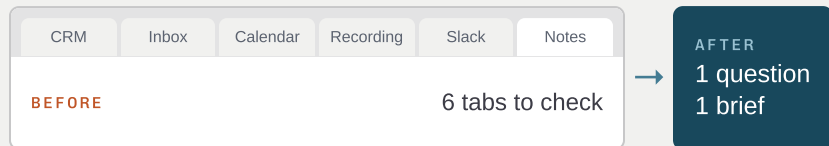


Ask for the brief. Let it pull live.

Two pre-call routines, side by side: the old habit, the prompt that replaces it, and why the new one sticks.

01 Pre-call prep

Ask, don't gather



INSTEAD OF

Opening six tabs before a call.

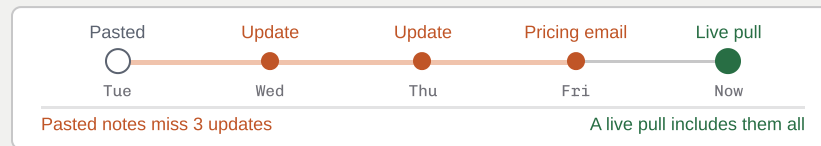
DO THIS

“Brief me on Vantage Retail: meetings in the last 30 days, open risks, and which contacts have been least active.”

WHY One ask replaces the hunt, and every line comes from captured activity.

02 Deal updates

Pull live, don't paste



INSTEAD OF

Pasting CRM notes into Claude and hoping they're current.

DO THIS

“Using Backstory, what's changed on Vantage Retail since last Tuesday?”

WHY It pulls the record live, so nothing goes stale.

Add a filter, a time window and a signal

Vague questions get vague answers. Build the habit of adding a filter, a signal and a time window, and every answer becomes a to-do list.

03 Pipeline check

Be specific, not general

INSTEAD OF

“How’s my pipeline?”



DO THIS

“Which of my deals closing this quarter have no exec contact in 30 days?”

— Filter

— Signal

— Time window

Result: a to-do list, not a vague summary.

04 Stakeholder map

Be specific, not general

INSTEAD OF

Rebuilding the buying group from memory.

DO THIS

“Who at Vantage Retail have we met with in the last 90 days, and who’s missing from the buying group?”

WHY See who’s engaged and who’s missing, based on real meetings.

05 Deal risk

Be specific, not general

INSTEAD OF

“Is this deal okay?”

DO THIS

“What are the top three risks on the Vantage Retail opportunity, and what’s the evidence for each?”

WHY Asking for evidence ties each risk to a real meeting or email.



Start from what's captured, not from memory

06 Follow-up email

Ask, don't gather

INSTEAD OF

Copying meeting notes into an email and rewriting them as a recap.

DO THIS

"Using Backstory, draft a follow-up to my last Vantage Retail meeting with the next steps we agreed."

DRAFT

MOCK DATA

Subject: Next steps from Tuesday's demo

Thanks for the time, Jordan. As agreed: revised pricing by Friday, security review kickoff next week, and a working session with your ops team on the 14th.

WHY The meeting is already captured.

07 Precedent

Ask, don't gather

INSTEAD OF

Asking around Slack for someone who's closed a deal like this.

DO THIS

"Find a similar deal to Vantage Retail and tell me how it was won."

SITUATION SEARCH

MOCK DATA

Vantage Retail
Retail · \$95K · Proposal



Northwind Goods

Won

Pinecrest Market

Won

Alder & Co.

Lost

WHY Finds comparable past deals, where enabled.



ROLE 02 · HABITS TO CHANGE

Sales manager

Forecasts, 1:1s and coaching, grounded in what reps actually did.

-
- 01 The weekly rhythm
Coaching focus · 1:1 prep · Forecast prep
 - 02 Inspect with structure
Deal inspection
 - 03 See across the team
At-risk accounts · Win patterns
-



Swap the prep behind every standing meeting

Your week already has a rhythm. Anchor one prompt to each standing meeting, and prep becomes a habit instead of a scramble.

MONDAY · TEAM REVIEW

Coaching focus

Be specific, not general

INSTEAD OF

Coaching from gut feel on who's struggling.

DO THIS

"Which of my team's accounts have had no meetings in the last 30 days, by owner?"

Coach from facts, not hunches. Backstory shows which accounts have gone quiet, so you know where to spend time.

TUESDAY · 1:1S

1:1 prep

Ask, don't gather

INSTEAD OF

Asking the rep to walk through every deal.

DO THIS

"Before my 1:1 with Priya, summarize her top five deals: recent activity, risks and next steps."

Backstory has the status. The 1:1 can start at coaching instead of a deal-by-deal readout.

WEDNESDAY · FORECAST CALL

Forecast prep

Pull live, don't paste

INSTEAD OF

Exporting the pipeline to a spreadsheet.

DO THIS

"Using Backstory, list Priya's open deals closing this quarter and flag any with new risks."

Backstory flags what moved and what's at risk, so the forecast call runs on evidence, not a rep's recall.

Give the answer a framework you can coach against

04 Deal inspection

Be specific, not general

INSTEAD OF

“Is Halden Freight going to close?”

DO THIS

“Evaluate the Halden Freight opportunity using MEDDPICC and flag the gaps.”

WHY A framework turns “I think so” into specific gaps to close.

Halden Freight · MEDDPICC

MOCK DATA

M	Metrics	Strong	Cost-per-mile target agreed
E	Economic buyer	Gap	CFO not engaged in 26 days
D	Decision criteria	Strong	Criteria shared in writing
D	Decision process	Partial	Procurement steps unclear
P	Paper process	Unknown	No legal contact yet
I	Identify pain	Strong	Fleet downtime costs confirmed
C	Champion	Strong	Dana Ruiz, VP Operations
C	Competition	Partial	Incumbent mentioned once

YOUR METHOD Swap in the methodology your team uses, such as MEDDIC, BANT, SPICED or Challenger.



Let patterns surface, instead of hunting for them

05 At-risk accounts

Be specific, not general

INSTEAD OF

Reading every call summary to find accounts going cold.

DO THIS

“Which accounts on my team have gone quiet in the last 30 days, ranked by deal size?”

GONE QUIET · RANKED BY SIZE

MOCK DATA

Halden Freight		\$240K · 26d
Corvia Health		\$180K · 34d
Beacon Labs		\$120K · 31d
Kestrel Air		\$85K · 40d

WHY Ranking by size shows where to look first.

06 Win patterns

Ask, don't gather

INSTEAD OF

Relying on anecdotes for what's working.

DO THIS

“Find past won deals similar to Halden Freight and tell me what worked.”

COMMON TO WON DEALS

MOCK DATA

8 of 10	Exec sponsor met before proposal
7 of 10	Three or more stakeholders engaged
6 of 10	Security involved during scoping

WHY One quarter, one team: specific enough to act on.



ROLE 03 · HABITS TO CHANGE

Customer success

Handoffs, renewals and expansion, with the full account story on hand.

01 One account, four moments

Sales handoff · QBR prep · Renewal prep · Expansion

02 Catch signals early

Quiet contacts · Book health



Corvia Health, from handoff to expansion

MOCK DATA

01

HANDOFF

Sales handoff

Pull live, don't paste

INSTEAD OF

A 30-minute handoff call to learn what was promised.

DO THIS

"Summarize what was promised to Corvia Health during the sales cycle: goals, commitments and open questions."

WHAT CHANGES

Start day one knowing every commitment

02

QBR

QBR prep

Ask, don't gather

INSTEAD OF

Building the QBR deck from a blank page.

DO THIS

"Draft a QBR outline for Corvia Health from this quarter's meetings and emails."

WHAT CHANGES

Walk in with the quarter already summarized

03

RENEWAL

Renewal prep

Ask, don't gather

INSTEAD OF

Piecing the renewal story together the week before.

DO THIS

"Using Backstory, summarize Corvia Health's last 90 days: meetings, open issues and renewal risks."

WHAT CHANGES

Spot renewal risk while there's time to act

04

EXPANSION

Expansion

Be specific, not general

INSTEAD OF

"Any expansion opportunities?"

DO THIS

"Which teams at Corvia Health have we met with outside the original buying group this quarter?"

WHAT CHANGES

Find new teams before a competitor does



See the drop-off while there's time to act

05 Quiet contacts

Be specific, not general

INSTEAD OF

Finding out your champion left when an email bounces.

DO THIS

“Which Corvia Health contacts haven’t been contacted in the last two weeks?”

MEETINGS · LAST 12 WEEKS

MOCK DATA

Dana Ruiz
Champion



Active

Sam Okafor
IT lead



Active

Lee Park
Exec sponsor



Gone quiet

Rita Gomez
Finance



Gone quiet

WHY Spot the drop-off before the renewal.

06 Book health

Be specific, not general

INSTEAD OF

Scanning your book account by account.

DO THIS

“Which of my accounts have had no meeting in the last 45 days?”

TWO FILTERS, ONE SHORT LIST

MOCK DATA

Your book

48 accounts

Renewing in 90 days

12 accounts

No meeting in 45 days

3 accounts

WHY Two filters turn a whole book into a short list.



What changes as the habit sticks

Start with one prompt. Within a few weeks it's routine, and the time you used to spend gathering goes back to customers.

Account executive		Sales manager		Customer success	
DAY 1	Prep one call by asking for a brief instead of opening tabs.	DAY 1	Prep one 1:1 from Backstory instead of a status readout.	DAY 1	Ask for a 90-day summary on one renewing account.
WEEK 2	Morning prep takes minutes. Follow-ups start from captured notes.	WEEK 2	Every standing meeting has a prompt. Forecast prep runs on evidence.	WEEK 2	Handoffs and QBR outlines start from what was captured.
MONTH 1	You ask sharper questions and spot quiet deals before they go cold.	MONTH 1	Coaching time goes to the deals that need a decision.	MONTH 1	Quiet contacts and book risk surface while there's time to act.

BEST PRACTICES TO KEEP

Name the tool

Start with "Using Backstory" so Claude pulls live data.

Scope the ask

Add an account, a time window and a signal.

Ask for receipts

"Which meetings and emails did you use?"

Anchor it

Tie one prompt to a meeting you already run.



THE TAKEAWAY

Name the tool. Scope
the ask. *Ask for receipts.*

Accounts, reps and deals shown are mock examples: Vantage Retail, Halden Freight, Corvia Health.

